

Social media apps

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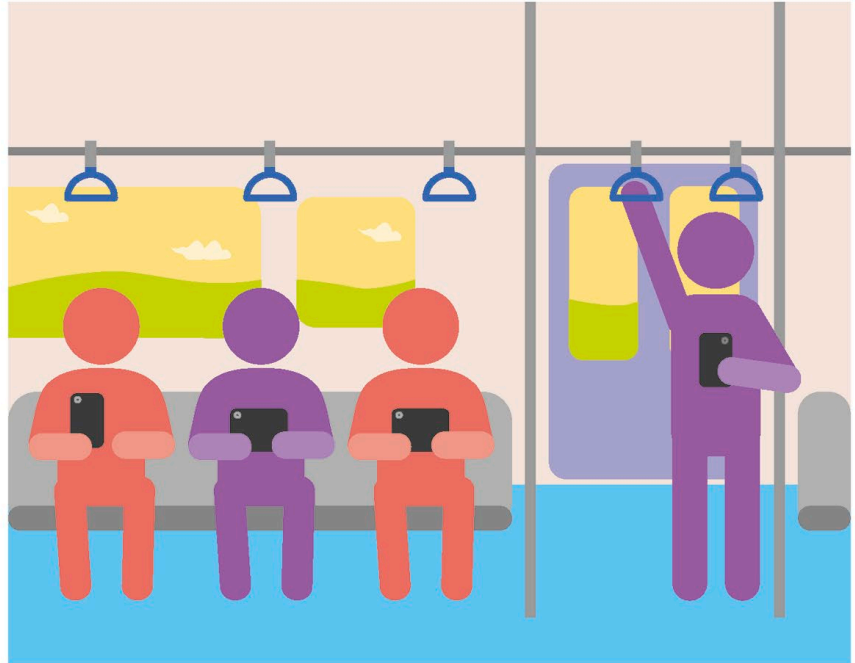
The rising popularity of social media has changed the way people communicate with each other. Thanks to various social media apps, it's now possible to stay connected with family and friends all the time.

Mobile first

In the early days of the internet, people used desktop computers or laptops to access internet. These days, handheld devices such as smartphones and tablets are now primarily used to access the web. The upside of this is that people are always connected, always on, always capturing, always uploading and downloading content – wherever they are. The downside, however, is that this may lead to information overload.

▷ On the go

Social media can be accessed from anywhere. Portable devices are as powerful as desktop computers and allow users to stay connected on the go.



Downloading social media apps

There are various ways to connect to a social media app. The first step is to download the app from an app store. Apps may be released by recognized developers such as Facebook or Google, or by smaller companies. Most apps are free, but some may have paid services or features. Bear in mind that some apps have age restrictions. Google Play, the Apple App Store, and the Microsoft Store are some of the popular distribution platforms.

Google Play

Android users can download a social media app from the Google Play store. This store allows anyone to upload apps, and therefore doesn't offer quality control. The apps uploaded are open source, which means that they can be tinkered with, and adapted by, anyone.

Apple App Store

The Apple App Store is where social media for iOS devices can be downloaded from. The Apple App Store has a very stringent policy for the apps that are uploaded there, and each one undergoes rigorous testing.

Microsoft Store

People using Windows on their tablets and smartphones can visit the Microsoft Store for social media apps. Though big social media companies usually offer their apps on the Microsoft Store, some smaller companies may take a while to have a version for Microsoft devices.